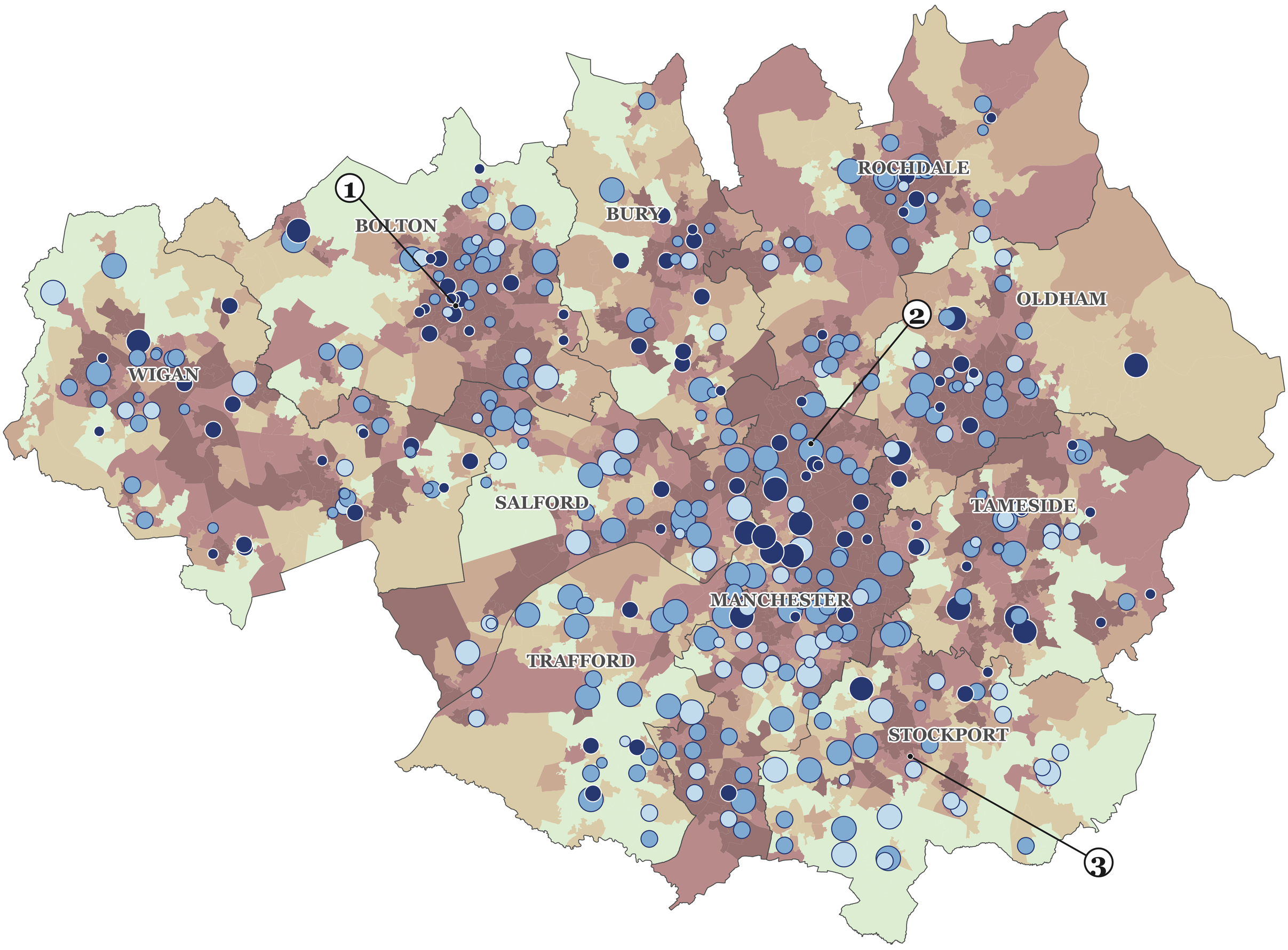
Small surgeries stretch their GPs furthest

Across Greater Manchester, 38% of small GP practices are in the busiest quarter for patients per GP, compared with 17% of large practices.

Each dot is a GP practice. Darker blue means more patients for each full-time GP; bigger dots are practices with more registered patients. The background shows how deprived each neighbourhood is.



① Central Bolton

10 of the 11 practices here are small, and 6 are in the busiest quarter for patients per GP.

② North Manchester

4 of the 6 practices here are in the busiest quarter. All of them serve patients from some of England's most deprived neighbourhoods.

③ Stockport

Practices here tend to be larger, and only 3 of Stockport's 32 practices are in the busiest quarter.

How this was measured. Patients per GP is registered patients divided by full-time-equivalent qualified GPs (partners and salaried GPs; trainees, locums and retainers are not counted). It measures GP capacity only: nurses, pharmacists and other practice staff are outside the count. Busy bands are quarters of Greater Manchester practices. Small practices have under 5,000 registered patients, large ones 10,000 or more. Shading describes neighbourhoods, not people: many people on low incomes live outside the darkest areas, and the reverse. 25 of 406 practices are not shown: 19 with no qualified GP or more than 6,000 patients per GP, and 6 with incomplete data.

Sources. NHS England: General Practice Workforce and Patients Registered at a GP Practice. MHCLG: English Indices of Deprivation 2025. ONS Postcode Directory (August 2026). Contains OS and ONS data, Crown copyright. GPs at 30 September 2026; registered patients at 1 October 2026; deprivation: IoD 2025 (published 17 November 2025).